A FREE GUIDE · BY NINA NIAMH

# The 10 Minute *Day Plan*

Ten minutes every morning. You paste your calendar, your to dos and the emails that matter. You get back one short brief that tells you what today is really about.

01 DAY AT A GLANCE

02 TACKLE TODAY

03 PREPARE

04 FOLLOW UP

05 ONE SIGNAL

NOTION STRUCTURE · CLAUDE PROMPT · FRIDAY REVIEW

# Your day already has a shape. *You just can't see it at 8am.*

Most mornings start the same way. You open the inbox, answer two easy things, glance at the calendar, and by ten you are reacting to whatever arrived last. The important work waits for a quiet afternoon that never comes.

Leaders with a chief of staff don't have this problem, and not because they work harder. Someone reads everything first and hands them one page: here is your day, here is what matters, here is who you need to answer, here is the thing you might be missing.

This guide is the manual version of that page. You do the collecting, Claude does the reading and the sorting, and in ten minutes you know:

- where your free time actually is today, in real gaps on the calendar
- the three things worth doing in those gaps, and the first action for each
- what you promised the people you are meeting
- who is waiting on you, before they have to ask twice
- one pattern across all of it that you would not notice on your own

> *The last part is the one I care about most. A signal is something that keeps showing up before anyone names it.*

I spend my working life building systems that read business signals. This is the smallest version of that idea: applied to one person and one morning.

02 · THE ROUTINE

# Ten minutes, *five steps.*

Do it before you open anything else. Same time, same order, every working day.

01 **Copy your calendar** 2 MIN

Open today in Google Calendar or Outlook. Select the day view and copy the events as text: time, title, who. Messy is fine.

02 **Copy your open to dos** 1 MIN

From the Tasks database (the "Copy for Claude" view) or wherever your list lives. Only what is still open.

03 **Skim the inbox for highlights** 3 MIN

Do not reply to anything yet. Copy sender, subject and the key line of the emails that matter: clients, anyone waiting, anything with a date in it.

04 **Paste into the prompt** 1 MIN

Open Claude, paste the daily prompt from page 6, drop your three blocks at the bottom, send.

05 **Read it, move it to Notion, start** 3 MIN

Paste the brief into today's page. Move the three tasks to Status "Today". Then do the first physical action of task one, before email.

## Two rules that make it work

One: you only paste, you never prepare. If you start tidying your notes before pasting, it becomes a forty minute ritual and you will drop it by Thursday. Two: if the brief says something you don't believe, check it, but don't argue with it. Its job is to show you the day as the data says it is.

# One page per day, *always in this order.*

Create a database called Daily Briefs. Each row is one day, and each row uses this page template. The order matters: you read top to bottom and the day gets more specific as you go.

| | |
|---|---|
| SECTION 1<br>**Day at a glance** | Events in time order with who is in them. Then every free gap of 30 minutes or more, with start and end time. This is the map for everything below. |
| SECTION 2<br>**Tackle today (3)** | Three tasks, never more. For each: why it matters today, the free gap where it fits, and the first physical action. A linked view of Tasks filtered to Status "Today" sits underneath. |
| SECTION 3<br>**Prepare** | One toggle per meeting: who, what you last discussed, what you promised them, and one question to ask. When there is no context, it says so instead of guessing. |
| SECTION 4<br>**Follow up** | Emails waiting on your reply, promises that are due, people who have gone quiet. One line each with a suggested first sentence, so replying takes a minute. |
| SECTION 5<br>**One signal** | One pattern across everything you pasted: something repeating, a person who shows up in three places, a risk building quietly. The pattern, the evidence, and what you might do. |

Daily Briefs properties: Name (title, the date) · Date · Energy (select: Low, Normal, High) · Tasks (relation to Tasks) · Signal (text, one line) · Reviewed (checkbox, ticked on Friday).

# A task list Claude *can actually read.*

Write every task as an action, verb first: "Send proposal to Ana", not "Proposal". These properties are all you need.

| PROPERTY | TYPE | HOW TO USE IT |
|---|---|---|
| Task | Title | Verb first, one action. |
| Status | Status | Inbox · Next · Today · Waiting · Done |
| Priority | Select | Must · Should · Could |
| Due | Date | Only real deadlines. Wishes don't get a date. |
| Effort | Select | 15 min · 30 min · 1 hour · 2 hours or more. Lets Claude fit tasks into gaps. |
| Area | Select | Clients · Product · Admin · Content · Personal. Rename to fit your life. |
| Person | Text | Who it is for, or who is waiting on it. |
| Promised | Checkbox | Tick it when you told someone you would do it. These feed Follow up. |
| Brief | Relation | To Daily Briefs. Set it when the task is picked for Tackle today. |
| Times picked | Rollup | Count of Brief. Three or more means it keeps slipping. |
| Created | Created time | Automatic. |

### VIEWS TO CREATE

Today · Open (board by Status) · Promised · Slipping (Times picked three or more) · Copy for Claude.

### THE PASTE VIEW

"Copy for Claude" is a table of open tasks showing only Task, Due, Effort and Person. Select all, copy, paste. Done.

# Copy it once. *Use it every morning.*

You are my chief of staff. Every morning I give you my calendar, my open to dos and the highlights of my inbox. Your job is to turn them into one short brief I can read in two minutes and act on.

Rules:
1. Use only what I paste below. If something is missing or unclear, say so in one line. Never invent meetings, people, promises or deadlines.
2. Write in plain, short sentences. No motivational language.
3. Times are in my local time zone. My working day runs from [START TIME] to [END TIME].
4. When you suggest where a task goes, place it in a real free gap in my calendar and say how long it needs.
5. If my day is already full, tell me honestly and suggest what to move.

Write the brief in exactly this format:

DAY AT A GLANCE
A list of today's events in time order (time, title, who). Then list the free gaps of 30 minutes or more, with start and end time.

TACKLE TODAY (3)
The three tasks that matter most today, chosen from my to dos and from anything urgent in my inbox. For each one: the task, why it matters today in one sentence, the free gap where it fits, and the first physical action to start it.

PREPARE
For each meeting today: who it is with, what we last discussed (from the inbox highlights, if present), what I promised them, and one question I should ask. If I gave you nothing about a meeting, write "No context pasted" instead of guessing.

FOLLOW UP
Emails that are waiting on my reply, promises I made that are due, and anyone who has gone quiet and should hear from me. One line each, with a suggested first sentence for my reply.

ONE SIGNAL
One pattern you notice across everything I pasted. Something repeating, a topic that keeps coming back, a person who appears in several places, a risk building up. State the pattern, the evidence in one line, and what I might do about it. If there is no clear pattern today, say so.

Here is today's material.

CALENDAR:
[paste today's events here]

TO DOS:
[paste your open tasks here]

INBOX HIGHLIGHTS:
[paste subject lines, senders and the key line of the emails that matter]

# Five briefs make a week. *Read them together.*

Friday afternoon, fifteen minutes. Paste the week's five briefs and your task list as it stands. This is where the single signals turn into something larger.

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You are my chief of staff. Below are my daily briefs from this week and my current task list.
Write my weekly review in this format, using only what I paste. Never invent anything.

WHAT MOVED
The tasks and decisions that actually got done this week. One line each.

WHAT SLIPPED
Tasks that appeared in Tackle Today more than once and still are not done. For each, suggest one
of three options: do it Monday, make it smaller, or drop it. Say which you would pick and why in
one sentence.

OPEN LOOPS
Promises and follow ups that are still open, with the person and the date I made them.

THE WEEK'S SIGNAL
Look across the five One Signal sections and everything else. What is the larger pattern this
week? State it, show the evidence, and tell me what it suggests for next week.

NEXT WEEK'S THREE
The three outcomes that would make next week a good week. Specific, finishable, each with a first
action for Monday morning.

MY BRIEFS THIS WEEK:
[paste here]

MY TASK LIST NOW:
[paste here]
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After the review: tick Reviewed on the week's briefs, deal with anything in the Slipping view, and put next week's three into Tasks with Status "Next".

# This is the manual version. *Daybrief runs it for you.*

Daybrief connects your own Gmail, Google Calendar and Notion and writes this exact brief before you wake up. Every morning, in your inbox and on your Notion "Today" page. Fridays, the weekly review.

- Two editions in one purchase: Claude edition (type /daybrief) and n8n edition (runs automatically at 06:30)
- Runs on your accounts. I never see your data
- About 60 minutes to set up, with videos and a written guide
- €347, one time

SEE DAYBRIEF ninaneev.github.io/daybrief.html

## The letter

Once a week I write about building in public, AI for solo founders, and reading the signals in your own work and life. You are already on the list because you downloaded this. If it ever stops being useful, unsubscribe in one click.

ninaneev.github.io/newsletter.html

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